



Dolphins find torpedo

Trained dolphins at a US navy facility discover a 130-year-old torpedo off the Californian coast. <http://dgit.in/118u1dS>



Sailfish on Jolla

The first phone running Sailfish, an open-source OS, is the Jolla <http://dgit.in/1ORDx6b>

Sennheiser: “We have a high level of respect for the Indian market”

We speak with Mr. Peter Callan, President – Consumer Electronics (Global) and Mr. Gunjan Srivastava, Managing Director, Sennheiser India on how the global market is shaping up, the brand and the future plans

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Sennheiser, in the face of some rather noisy rivals, has kept a very calm demeanor and pretty much stuck to their philosophy and plans. We speak with Mr. Peter Callan, Global President of Consumer Electronics and Mr. Gunjan Srivastava, Managing Director at Sennheiser India on a variety of topics – how the market is shaping up globally, in India specifically, the rivals, the brand and design philosophies and the upcoming products.

Q How is Sennheiser doing in the Indian market? How important is India for Sennheiser, in terms of brand, volume and numbers?

Gunjan Srivastava: We have gone through some very exciting phase in the last 6 years, right from the time when we launched to where we are today. In terms of lines of businesses, we have three units – consumer – which is today the largest business unit for us in India and globally, professional and we are now getting into a third business which is integrated systems which is providing solutions to offices, educational institutes, places of worship and hospitals. In all business, we have been growing high double digits in the last 6 years

Q How much of Sennheiser's focus will be on markets like India, China and Brazil, because they have become heavy gadget consumers off late.

Peter Callan: India is a strategically important



Peter Callan, President – Consumer Electronics (Global)

market for us, and our approach to the market is long-term, and it's personal. We are not here for a quick win, we are not here to take what we do in other places and impose it on the Indian market. We view our development plan in India on a 5-10-15 year basis, which fits with the heritage of the Sennheiser brand, and the way we have done business and the way we have approached targets.



Gunjan Srivastava, Managing Director, Sennheiser India

Q Sennheiser is a specialized company is a fairly specialized market. Most of your rivals have gone for volumes with cheaper audio products. How does that impact Sennheiser? Do you have plans for taking on the rivals with mass market products of your own?

PC: It is a very dynamic marketplace, globally, and it is a very competitive landscape. What we focus on is our

brand, our core values and our heritage and positioning which that gives us. We will be pursuing our premium brand strategy and positioning. But we will be doing that in a way that is relevant in the context of the market here. We will not be going into the mass volume driven market segment, however we will be fine-tuning our way of bringing the brand to the end use.

Q How does Sennheiser decide which technology goes into which product? For example, the HD448, the HD598 and the Momentum are fairly different headphones, with a similar price gap between each! Is there a price band categorization of where certain features and specs go?

PC: We have certain fundamentals that have to be present in any product – it has to feel premium, it has to fit with the brand, it has to bring something special to the user in terms of innovation or design and style. And then we think of technology. What is the most relevant technology at a particular price point? What is the most relevant technology in any particular market because not all markets are open to all technologies or are as ready for all the technologies? So, it's not a straight arithmetic calculation. It is considering all the factors around the portfolio – which products are going into which markets, what the state of technology evolution is, how particular products and technology solutions fit with the brand, how we bring in the design aspect, innovation aspect – so it's a rather complex evaluation of all of those factors I would say. And it becomes, at the end, very specific to specific markets and its dynamic. Taking India as an example, the kind of solution or value proposition we bring in the Indian market today would be different in two years – it will evolve with the market and user requirements. **Q**